

Your Defense Against the Lust of Other Things

In our study of Satan's tactics, we found out that he is smarter than any military genius who has ever lived. We also found out that Jesus said:

Behold, I give unto you power
over all the power of the enemy:
and nothing shall by any means hurt you.

If we really have power over all the power of the enemy, that means Satan has to deceive you and me as believers. He has to deceive us into accepting our own defeat.

We have been studying the forces he uses or hides behind to effect that defeat. There could not be a better chapter than Mark 4, the pilot chapter we chose to study these weapons.

In review, verse 14 gives the subject:

The sower soweth the word.

That is the subject. The objective is how to take the Word of God, guard against these five things, and produce up to a hundredfold based on the Word of God.

We have studied persecutions, afflictions, the cares of life, and the deceitfulness of riches. Now we are on the lusts of other things.

Mark 4:18-19 says:

And these are they which are sown among thorns;
such as hear the word,
And the cares of this world,
and the deceitfulness of riches,
and the lusts of other things entering in,
choke the word,
and it becometh unfruitful.

The Word becomes unfruitful in the life of that believer.

Persecutions, afflictions, and cares all come at you from without. The last two, the deceitfulness of riches and the lusts of other things, are at the end of the list because they are the most powerful forces the devil has. They burn on you from the inside.

If he cannot push you over the edge by pressure, cares, persecutions, and afflictions, if you refuse to fall and will not let him have the Word, then he changes his tactics. He turns two of his most powerful tools on you: the deceitfulness of riches and the lusts of other things.

The deceitfulness of riches runs hand in hand with the lusts of other things. Most generally, the reason a man wants great wealth outside of God is so he can satisfy lusts for other things, the gratification of the flesh.

But there are people deceived by riches who do not have any. Their deceitfulness lies in continually trying to get it, even to the degree of using people.

Yesterday we gave Scriptures and stories from the Bible showing how the lusts of other things entered in and actually choked what Word of God was in the people who possessed it.

I named ministries that persecutions, afflictions, cares, and even the deceitfulness of riches could not stop. These men could not be bought. But that last one got them: the lusts of other things, self-exaltation, and gratification of the flesh.

I have known men who operated powerfully in God and near the end of their ministry, almost a full course, fell to the gratification of the flesh. The lusts of other things wore on them and wore on them until finally it wore them down and they gave up.

One lust of other things is power, self-exaltation. Even men that money could not buy fell to self-glorification:

"I am the man of the hour."

It has happened.

The lusts of other things are the final trick in the devil's bag to knock God's children out of the saddle. It is undoubtedly the most powerful. Tonight we are going to study why.

Many times I have studied with you on walking in the Spirit, what it means to walk in the Spirit and not after the lusts of the flesh.

That is the message God commissioned me to preach since I moved to Tulsa from Medford, Oregon:

"Teach My people how to walk in the Spirit. Teach them how to merge the Word of God they know with the Holy Ghost and the revelation knowledge contained in it. Teach them by the Spirit how to make the Word of God they know work, and how to mortify the flesh so that it does not dominate them, but they dominate it."

I have seen so many people survive persecution, afflictions, cares, and the deceitfulness of riches. These men could not be bought, but they fell to that last one.

In meditating on this and praying in the Holy Ghost, I said, "Lord, how come all the rest of those forces cannot get a man, but this last one in Satan's bag of tricks is the one more have fallen to? Why?"

God began to unfold it.

It does not matter if it takes the devil twenty, thirty, or forty years. He will wear you down with the flesh. The reason he can wear on you is because the body we are wearing right now was given to us by the first Adam, not the last one, Jesus Christ.

Because it was given to you by the first Adam, you still have death working in this flesh you inherited from the first Adam.

At the sound of the trumpet, we are going to get a new body. It is called glorified. You could not make that thing sin if you threw a stick at it.

It will happen in the twinkling of an eye, at the sound of the trumpet, when corruption gives way to incorruption and we are raised to be with Him in that state forevermore.

But whether you have noticed or not, your outer man is falling apart. Some people die a lot harder than others. Five or six facelifts in Hollywood, because they inherited death, corruption, and imperfection. As of yet, that is working in your body.

I did not say it is working in your spirit. We have been seated in heavenly places with Christ Jesus. I am a new creation. I have entered into Zoe, the God-kind of eternal life, present, past, future, forever existing in a state of new-birth creation with Jesus Christ.

That has already entered my spirit. I am a new creation.

But the physical body you are wearing has yet to undergo redemption. It is dying. The thing is perishing on you.

When a believer sins, and believers do, he did not sin out of his new creation reality. You have the nature of Jesus Christ in your spirit. You did not sin out of there.

Somehow it originated with the flesh.

The problem is the temptations of the flesh. They war against you, and they will not go away until the sound of the trumpet. This battle is long. It lasts all your life.

When everything else fails, persecutions, afflictions, cares, and riches, that lust for other things, the flesh, will keep wearing on you until you are ninety-one, ninety-two, or ninety-three.

That is why Satan wears so many saints out and gets them after a long, extended ministry. This one does not go away. It keeps wearing on you.

There is only one defense that I know of:

Walk in the Spirit,
and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.

It is through the Spirit that you mortify the deeds of the body. It is not in your own strength that you win this one. It is in His strength. You do not have enough to whip it.

If a man does not learn this, I guarantee you he will eventually wear out.

Remember when religion began to lose its zest and became a chore to go to church? Remember?

Let us look at 1 John 5:16.

1 John 5:16 says:

If any man see his brother sin a sin
which is not unto death,
he shall ask,
and he shall give him life
for them that sin not unto death.
There is a sin unto death:
I do not say that he shall pray for it.

All unrighteousness is one form of sin or another, but there is a sin not unto death.

Then verse 18 says:

We know that whosoever is born of God sinneth not.

How many of you are born of God? How many of you sin not?

We could do like the rest of the theologians, tear that page out, and throw it away. But perhaps we should not tear it out until we get the Holy Ghost on it.

Verse 16 says if any man sees his brother sin. What is a brother except a believer? It says a brother can sin.

But verse 18 says:

We know that whosoever is born of God sinneth not;
but he that is begotten of God keepeth himself,
and that wicked one toucheth him not.

There is only one begotten of God. I am born of God, but there is only one begotten of God. He existed before He was born of God. That is Jesus Christ.

The reason I could not understand verse 18 is because of the phrase, "He that is begotten of God keepeth himself." The word "himself" actually translates from the Greek as "him." It threw everything off.

What he is actually saying is this:

If any man sees his brother sin a sin that is not unto death, he can ask God, and God will give him life. He can act as an intercessor and go between the devil, the sin, and that man, and God will give that intercessor life to break the power of the devil off his brother.

Then he went on to say, "Whosoever is born of God sinneth not."

Why? Because the only begotten of God, Jesus Christ, keeps him. He keeps that man in the realm of the spirit, and the devil cannot get his spirit.

He is saying that the one born of God does not sin out of the new creation reality because the Begotten of God keeps him, and Satan cannot touch him. The sin originates with the flesh, not the spirit.

To clear that up, back up to 1 John 5:1:

Whosoever believeth that Jesus is the Christ
is born of God:
and every one that loveth him that begat
loveth him also that is begotten of him.

That is me. I believe Jesus is the Savior, the Christ, therefore I am born of God.

Everyone who loves Him that begot also loves the One begotten of Him. God is the One who begot. If I love the One who begot Jesus, then I love the One who is begotten of Him, which is Jesus Christ.

So it is no surprise when he says there is a sin unto death and he does not say to pray for that. He that is born of God does not sin out of his spirit because the Begotten One keeps him in that realm. Satan cannot touch him, kill him, unborn him, or do anything to him.

So where does the sin come from?

It comes from the lusts of other things.

It is one thing to know I am capable of it. Another thing is to say, "For God's sake, I want to know what to do about it." I want to spend my entire lifetime walking in the right direction. I do not want to spend years and then fall to something that wore on me for twenty years.

I have seen men of God rise to heights in God and then fall to alcoholism.

One man of God told me about a man responsible for a revival in a nation that turned it from almost entirely Catholic to Protestant. At the end of the day, if you wanted to know where the revival was, all you had to do was follow the traffic and the line of people. They were all going to the meeting in a large bullfighting ring.

Ambulances passed people over the crowd's heads, and before the people got to the front of a crowd of 250,000, the ambulances had returned to the hospitals for another load. Everybody was walking off healed.

Yet if you knew how this man ended the last days of his life, you would say, "Roberson, I think what you are about to tell me will be the most important thing I have ever heard."

You would be right.

Satan saves the lusts of other things until last because it is the most powerful deceptive thing he has. You will hear of a preacher you thought was outstanding, and then they catch him in some kind of sin.

You say, "My God, I would never have suspected."

Yes, but the thing got him on one hand while he maintained a facade on the other, until he was exposed. The lusts of other things got too heavy for him to bear. He could not cope with it and did not know how. So he was forced to live two lives, what we commonly refer to as a hypocrite.

I am not as concerned with their sin as I am with how to recover a man of God.

The lusts of other things enter in and choke the operation of the Word of God out of a man's life. If these are dealing with flesh, and they are, then if He says it is through the Spirit that I mortify, I must know how the Holy Spirit does this.

Romans 8:13 says:

For if ye live after the flesh,
ye shall die:
but if ye through the Spirit
do mortify the deeds of the body,
ye shall live.

Then the Spirit of Grace spoke:

"Would that men would lift holy hands and pray everywhere, making supplications and all prayer in the Spirit, watching thereunto for all saints. Watch that you enter not into the temptations of the flesh, but pray for brethren everywhere, that you might stand strong in these last days. Where

sin and the empowerment of it does abound, grace will much more abound. Therefore, be taught of the Teacher, be taught of the Holy Spirit, and learn the walk of the Spirit. You shall be victorious, for the battle is Mine, but the victory is yours, saith the Spirit of Grace."

He can teach better than I do.

Heavenly Father, how do I deal with the flesh? How do I keep a long relationship where the flesh does not overpower me, but I overpower it?

Romans 8:13 says:

But if ye through the Spirit
do mortify the deeds of the body,
ye shall live.

Verse 14 says:

For as many as are led by the Spirit of God,
they are the sons of God.

As many as will accept the leadership of the Spirit in their life, as many as will employ these principles, are the sons of God. They have come to a place of maturity and full age where their flesh and all its forces have no power to dominate them.

As many as will be led by the Spirit, day by day, inch by inch, step by step, mile by mile, He will lead out of the walk where the flesh dominates you and into that glorious, liberated walk of power in His Spirit, where you dominate the flesh.

It is through the Spirit that we mortify.

I have always known the Holy Spirit is the all-powerful One. I have always known He is my source of strength. But I have not always known how to tap into it.

Sometimes I felt like slapping preachers. I was so frustrated, dominated by different things, and could not see myself free from them. Those preachers guaranteed me it was through the power of the Spirit, but not one of them told me how to do it.

You do not have to tell me the Holy Spirit is the all-powerful One and the source of my strength. Who does not know that? What we did not know in the face of defeat was how to get that power out of here and onto the problem.

Many of us have gone down under a flailing array of defeat: problems, nasty habits, anger, things we could not seem to get free from.

The Holy Ghost says if you through the Spirit mortify the deeds of the body, you will live. As many as accept this kind of leadership will arrive at this place of maturity.

Romans 8:15 explains the leadership:

For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption,
whereby we cry,
Abba, Father.

Which spirit did He say we did not receive? The spirit of bondage, corruption, and fear. All bondage, corruption, and fear come from the flesh and Satan's empowerment of it.

He said that is not your spirit. The one you received is the one that empowers you to cry, "Abba! You are the Father of my spirit."

It does not matter how damnable the test gets. It does not matter how hard Satan turns up the lust until you are fighting it with everything in you. The corruption, bondage, fear, poverty, sickness, disease, and care did not come from God.

The one that came from God is buried under all of that, crying, "Abba, You are the Father of my spirit," and that is more powerful than anything Satan has sent against you.

Which one are you learning to listen to?

I know the other one is louder. Bondage, corruption, and fear are louder because you live here. But we exist in the kingdom of God.

The quicker you learn to reach inside where that little domain of peace is wanting to dominate your whole being, the quicker you will learn where the power is. You may think there is not enough power in it to dominate your whole being, yet all the time it is crying, "Abba, Abba, You are the Father of my spirit."

How many times have you wanted to give up? Some of you thought you had. But a little lava on the inside wore on you until you came back. It would not let you give up. It frustrated you until finally you came back to God.

When we first moved to Oregon, I got a job falling trees, thinning trees. I was about twenty-six or twenty-seven years old.

A man came from Los Angeles and got a job falling trees with us. We finally nicknamed him Fort, after the town he came from.

He was so skinny he looked like a shoestring. I found out he had burned his body and brain out taking drugs. He could not go without his drugs. Besides all that, he was a habitual liar. He would forget you were with him five minutes ago and lie about it.

I worked on him and worked on him until he finally said, "I want to get born again."

I took him into my tent. We were camping at Lake of the Woods in Oregon. In those days, I was ultra-Pentecostal holiness, and we did not let up praying for someone if it took all night until they felt something. They had better feel saved.

The only way I really knew how to pray was to scream and yell, because that was how my elders did it.

"In the name of Jesus! Did you feel anything yet?"

The next morning, all the tents around us, in what looked like a quarter-mile circle, packed up and moved out because we screamed in tongues all night long and finally got him filled.

My boss was upset the next day. His wife was throwing pans around. He said, "If this is what that religious stuff is about, you can forget me."

Three days later, we had him on the other side too. He said, "Do me a favor. When you pray me through, take me to the other side of the lake where there is not anybody."

Three days later, Fort disappeared for a couple of days. He had gone into town, gotten high again, gotten drunk, raced his car, and played music so loud it would blow your eardrums out the windows.

When he came back on the job, he stayed clear away from me. I finally talked to him and found out what he did. I got defensive for God: "You said you had something."

I found out God does not need my help defending Him. He said, "Roberson, live for Me. That is quite enough."

I was hurt for God, but I am glad God does not write people off like we do.

He reminded me of a man who came into a service doped up. His eyes were dilated, big around. He was sitting on the front row. I hardly knew what was wrong with him.

I said, "Anybody want to be born again?"

He raised his hand.

I said, "You want to be born again?"

He nodded.

I said, "Repeat after me. Dear Lord Jesus, come into my heart."

He just stood there. After I was done, he still stood there like that, and I said, "Sit him down."

His hair was in a ponytail all the way down to his waist, and it seemed like he majored in how long you could go without taking a bath.

A month later, I came back to that town. A very neatly groomed young gentleman came in with about seventeen people lined up with him.

He said, "Hi, do you remember me?"

I said, "No."

He said, "I got born again in your meeting last month."

I thought, "There was only one guy born again in my meeting last month."

He said, "That was me."

He went on to get filled with the Holy Ghost and brought seventeen of his friends with him. I had not thought he got anything.

At the end of that cutting season, Fort went his way and I went mine. I entered the ministry at thirty years old. Three or four years later, I had a joint meeting in Klamath Falls, where all the cooperating churches came together.

I preached a good message and was in the back room recovering, and this little fat boy came walking in.

He said, "Do you remember me?"

I said, "No."

He gave me his name, and it meant nothing to me.

He said, "You nicknamed me Fort."

I said, "Who?"

He said, "Fort. I used to work with you in the woods."

I thought of the Fort I knew: a drug user and habitual liar.

He said, "That was me."

I said, "You are Fort? What are you doing in this meeting?"

He said, "Did you not know? I am one of the cooperating pastors."

I said, "Fort, please tell me what happened."

He said, "I went back to Los Angeles. I had doped it and drunk it as long as I could. I was worse than ever. But something on the inside knocked on me day after day. Every time I drove by one of those churches with the door open because they could not afford air conditioning, they would be singing in tongues, and I would hear those tongues again. Something inside me wanted to turn in. Finally it wore me out. I turned in, got born again again, went on a crash course, established myself, entered the ministry, and now I am pastoring up here in Oregon."

That means all of you who have children in the world who once knew Jesus can know they are suffering the same syndrome. They are coming back.

It is stronger than bondage, corruption, and fear. The quicker you learn to walk according to that inner witness, that Abba on the inside of you, the quicker you learn the walk of the Spirit.

They that walk in the Spirit do not fulfill the wars and lusts of the flesh. It is through the Spirit that you mortify.

Romans 8:16 says:

The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit,
that we are the children of God:
And if children,
then heirs;
heirs of God,
and joint-heirs with Christ;
if so be that we suffer with him,
that we may be also glorified together.

Then verse 18 says:

For I reckon that the sufferings of this present time
are not worthy to be compared
with the glory
which shall be revealed in us.

What does it mean?

We have not received bondage, corruption, and fear. We received that Spirit on the inside that cries, "Abba, You are the Father of my spirit."

That inner witness is the Holy Spirit bearing witness with my human spirit that I am His child. When He bears witness that I am His child, my human spirit cries, "Abba, Daddy God, You are the Father and keeper of my spirit."

That same tiny witness also made me an heir of God and a joint heir with Jesus Christ.

A joint heir does not mean half yours and half mine. It means everything you have is mine, and everything I have is yours. We are joint heirs.

That tiny witness in me that exists at this very moment has made me a joint heir with Jesus Christ.

I kept asking my Father, "A joint heir with what?"

Finally, after only seven years, it dawned on my lightning-quick mind. He said we are joint heirs with Him if we suffer with Him, that we may also be glorified together.

The word "glorified" refers to when the trumpet sounds and corruption gives way to incorruption, when I am glorified together with Jesus in my glorified body.

If the glorified with Him is talking about my body, then what are the sufferings?

I am a joint heir with Jesus because Jesus found Himself in the fashion of a man. He was clothed in flesh much like you are wearing. He died, resurrected again, and God gave Him a glorified body.

As of yet, I have a witness on the inside because I have been born again, but I am still wearing a body that was given to me by the first Adam.

Do you know why I am not worried about it? I am a joint heir with Him. He has already risen, and I am next in line.

Therefore the sufferings of this present time, the devil's wars against my flesh in a lifetime of suffering, are not worthy to be compared with the moment when this body gives way to glorification and I receive my joint inheritance.

This flesh is going to cause that kind of suffering. You are wearing a body capable of sin.

Do you think this body is going to quit warring against you before glorification? It will not. That is why He said you are a joint heir.

The bondage and corruption do not come from Him. You are a joint heir, and that is what you have been made by the inner witness because you are born again. You are His child. You can cry, "Abba."

I reckon that a lifetime of walking after the Spirit and telling your body, "Shut up. You are not telling me how long I am going to pray. You are not telling me what I am going to do for God or not. You are not going to make me sin," cannot be compared to that moment of glorification when this war gives way to the sound of the trumpet.

Then I receive one resurrected body fashioned in the image of His own, out of the jurisdiction of bondage, disease, sin, and poverty, in absolute liberty. At that point in history, I will be born of the last Adam, a manifested son of God, spirit, soul, and body.

Tonight we found out that the lusts of other things entering in can destroy the root of the Word in a man. But it is the Spirit's role, and through the Spirit you can mortify and stop the body.

He went on to give some of our redemption rights. He showed where corruption, bondage, and fear come from, and what that inner witness has made you and me.

Before we finish this tomorrow night, we are going to find out how the Holy Ghost activates your spirit to bring your flesh to the redemptive position that has been declared.